

To ensure that your tracking is useful and, more importantly, accurate, there are certain settings that you will need to configure.

Setting up views

This setting will allow you to lay out filters through which you can view your data. The default setting for this is the Google Analytics view called 'All Website Data', which comes with no filters of its own. It is wise to keep the default setting as it is so that you have untethered access to all the raw data from your website.

Each business comes with its own views. In order to add new views for your specific business, you can visit the Admin tab. Click on the column dropdown and click on 'create a new view'. It is recommended that you add views in order to filter out certain pages on your website that will not count towards your eventual goals. For instance, you should have a filter in place that will avoid counting the views of your employees because these will give you a false-positive reading. What you want to count are the visits made by website visitors and not by your employees.

Setting up goals

So you have managed to count the number of pageviews on your website and a good number of people seem to be visiting your website. But what are they doing when they are on your website? Are they meaningfully interacting with your website? Setting up goals will allow you to track their sessions and understand where people are spending their time and if they are completing important tasks such as filling out a contact form, or is there a particular product page that is getting more attention as compared to the others, etc.

To set up goals, let's take an example. Let's say you want to track purchase completions on your website, measured by the number of times a website visitor sees a purchase confirmation (or thank you) page after their purchase.

To go to Goals, click on Admin > View (column) > Goals.

Click on the 'New Goal' button. Go through the drop-down list that appears. Check if they match the task you are looking for. If they do not, you can add a specific one by clicking on 'custom' and adding it in there. Don't forget to give your new goal a name that you can easily recollect. Select destination and click on the tab called 'next step'. From here on, look for the URL of your confirmation page. There is a part of your URL segment that needs to be copied into the destination field. Choose the segment after the '.com' (for instance - [/confirmation.html](#)). After pasting it in the destina-